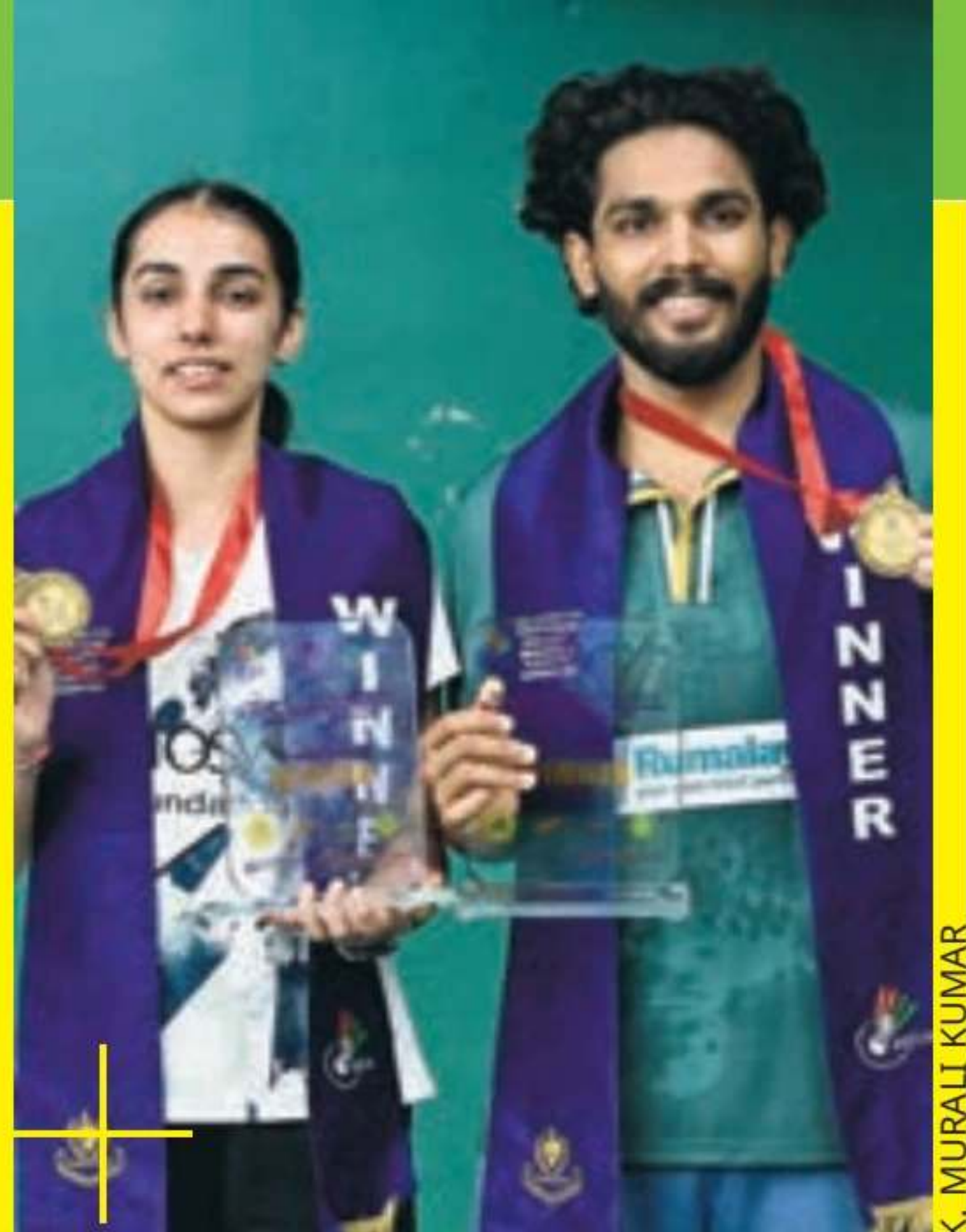




K. MURALI KUMAR

Raghu, Devika clinch crowns



In a thriller, Karnataka's M. Raghu saved three championship points to defeat Railways' Mithun Manjunath 14-21, 21-14, 24-22 for his maiden Senior National Championship men's singles title at the Karnataka Badminton Association (KBA) courts in Bengaluru.

In contrast, the women's singles final had none of the drama as Haryana's Devika Sihag, 19, secured her first National crown with a straightforward 21-15, 21-16 triumph over Telangana's Shriyanshi Valishetty.

The results (all finals):

Men's singles: M. Raghu (Kar) bt Mithun Manjunath (Rly) 14-21, 21-14, 24-22.

Women's singles: Devika Sihag (Har) bt Shriyanshi Valishetty (Tel) 21-15, 21-16.

Men's doubles: Arsh Mohammad (UP) & Sanskar Saraswat (Raj) bt P. Naveen & V. Lokesh (TN) 21-12, 12-21, 21-19.

Women's doubles: Arathi Sara Sunil (Ker) & V.S. Varshini (TN) bt Priya Devi Konjengbam (Mnp) & Shruti Mishra (UP) 21-18, 22-20, 17-21.

Mixed doubles: Ayush Agarwal & Shruti Mishra (UP) bt Rohan Kapoor (Del) & G. Ruthvika Shivani (Pet) 21-17, 21-18

N. SUDARSHAN

INDIAN PLAYGROUND

SPORTOON



1 Uttar Pradesh boys and Tamil Nadu girls emerged champions in the 49th sub-junior national basketball championship at Saroornagar Indoor Stadium in Hyderabad. In the boys' final, UP scored a hard-fought 56-49 victory over Delhi after leading 34-30 at halftime. UP owed its victory to the trio of Jatin, Darshil and Kaushal, whereas for Delhi, Yadav and Shivam put up a good show. In the girls' final, Tamil Nadu scored an easy 68-46 win against Maharashtra after leading 35-15 at halftime. Tamil Nadu played a fast-paced game from the start with Swathika and Mercy dominating the offence.

TEAM SPORTSTAR

2 Vaishnavi Adkar outplayed Elena Jamshidi of Japan 6-2, 6-1 in the final of the \$15,000 ITF women's tennis tournament at the Ace Academy in Palodiya. It was a maiden title in the professional circuit for the 20-year-old Vaishnavi, who did not drop a set along the way. She made it doubly special by winning the doubles title later in partnership with Pooja Ingale. The Indian pair saved three match points in the super tiebreak at 6-9 to beat the Japanese Honoka Kobayashi and Anri Nagata 6-3, 2-6, [12-10].

TEAM SPORTSTAR